

■ 2.6.19 Interactive Input

When you write programs in *Mathematica*, you will sometimes want a program to stop, and ask for input from the user.

<code>Input[]</code>	read one input expression
<code>Input["prompt"]</code>	issue a prompt, then read one input expression
<code>InputString[]</code>	read a string of input
<code>InputString["prompt"]</code>	issue a prompt, then read a string

Interactive input.

`Input` is intended for reading in complete *Mathematica* expressions. `InputString`, on the other hand, reads in arbitrary character strings. You should realize then when you evaluate `Input` or `InputString`, *Mathematica* waits until it has received the appropriate *Mathematica* expression, or character string. If you do not enter any input, *Mathematica* will just keep on waiting.

Particularly when you use *Mathematica* with a graphical front end, the mechanism by which `Input` and `InputString` actually get their input may be quite sophisticated. A typical thing is for `Input` and `InputString` to tell the front end to put up a “dialog box” into which the input can be entered.